

Daniel Radcliffe and the Art of Playing a "Weird Little Guy"

From: /Film Mined: 2026-10-04 5 min read

A film writer says there is a fun way to see how far Daniel Radcliffe has come since he starred in the **Harry Potter** movies. In an **opinion piece**, the writer recommends the 2016 movie "Swiss Army Man," which is now **streaming** on Netflix. The film was written and directed by Daniel Scheinert and Daniel Kwan, known as "the Daniels," who later made "Everything Everywhere All at Once." Paul Dano also stars. The writer calls the movie "absolutely wild in the best way" and says it is an important part of Radcliffe's growth as an actor.

The writer also uses the internet phrase "**weird little guy**." It describes an actor who can turn into strange, unusual characters. The writer says it is about a state of mind, not size, and gives Nicholas Hoult, Robert Pattinson and Alexander Skarsgård as examples. Radcliffe, the writer says, is a great example too.

According to the writer, Radcliffe has worked hard since **Harry Potter** to avoid being tied to that role. His roles include a man who grows horns in "Horns," a sneaky villain in "Now You See Me 2" and "The Lost City," and a heightened version of musician "Weird Al" Yankovic in "Weird: The Al Yankovic Story."

Radcliffe has also done a lot of **stage work**, in shows such as "Equus" and "How to Succeed in Business Without Really Trying." He won his first **Tony Award** for a Broadway revival of "Merrily We Roll Along." On television, he starred in "Miracle Workers." In 2026 he stars with Tracy Morgan in a comedy called "The Fall and Rise of Reggie Dinkins," which the writer praises as one of the best comedies on air.

Word Treasure

opinion piece -- An article that shares the writer's own views.

streaming -- Watching a show or movie over the internet.

Harry Potter -- The movie series that made Radcliffe famous.

weird little guy -- An internet phrase for an actor who turns into strange characters.

Tony Award -- A major award for theater.

stage work -- Acting in plays and musicals.

Break it down

Opening: a writer's idea for seeing Radcliffe's growth

The movie "Swiss Army Man" and its makers

The phrase "weird little guy" and examples

Radcliffe's roles since Harry Potter

Stage work and a Tony Award

The 2026 comedy with Tracy Morgan

Why it matters

It shows how actors can grow past one famous role, and readers can use the writer's view to pick something new to watch.

Test what you remember

1. What kind of article is this?

- ☐ (A) An opinion piece by a film writer
- ☐ (B) A science study
- ☐ (C) A news report about a crime
- ☐ (D) A school rulebook

2. Who are known as "the Daniels"?

- ☐ (A) Radcliffe and Tracy Morgan
- ☐ (B) The cast of Harry Potter
- ☐ (C) Daniel Scheinert and Daniel Kwan
- ☐ (D) Two Netflix executives

3. Which later movie did "the Daniels" make?

- ☐ (A) Now You See Me 2
- ☐ (B) Everything Everywhere All at Once
- ☐ (C) The Lost City
- ☐ (D) Horns

4. Which actors does the writer name as examples of "weird little guys" besides Radcliffe?

- ☐ (A) Only Paul Dano
- ☐ (B) No other actors
- ☐ (C) Tracy Morgan and Daniel Kwan
- ☐ (D) Nicholas Hoult, Robert Pattinson and Alexander Skarsgård

5. In "Horns," what happens to Radcliffe's character?

- ☐ (A) He moves to the moon
- ☐ (B) He sprouts horns
- ☐ (C) He becomes invisible
- ☐ (D) He loses his voice

6. What does the writer say about Radcliffe's 2026 comedy?

- ☐ (A) It is a documentary
- ☐ (B) It is one of the best comedies on air
- ☐ (C) It was cancelled
- ☐ (D) It is for toddlers

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: C 3: B 4: D 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

1. The film writer: Praises Radcliffe's choice of unusual roles and calls his 2026 comedy one of the best on air.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):